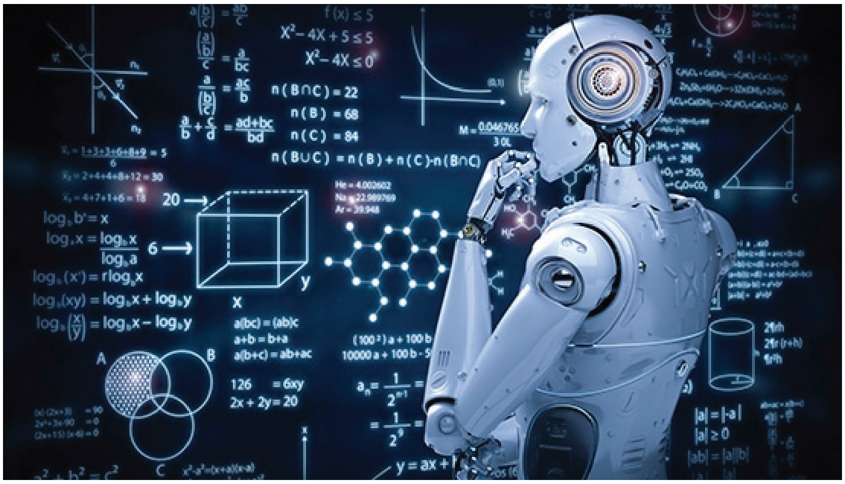
MOSS, a ChatGPT-like program, goes open source



Shanghai based Fudan University's MOSS, a ChatGPT-like AI bot, has become open source in an effort to establish a 'China path' for the use of creative AI tools. According to Qiu Xipeng, the director of MOSS's developers and a researcher at the School of Computer Science at Fudan University, organisations and programmers can now access MOSS's codes on GitHub for free, starting mid-April.

With significant backers like Microsoft, ChatGPT and its creator OpenAI have access to extensive financial and data resources. Chinese developers, including the tech giant Baidu, have scarce means in comparison. The majority of data is separate and not shared, leading businesses to perform a lot of redundant work.

Compared to ChatGPT, MOSS has fewer parameters and interactive statistics. However, when it has access to external knowledge bases or learns to look for or use tools in particular areas, its capabilities will be improved, according to experts.

On February 20, just after the pilot test for MOSS went live, the website was inundated with fervent visitors. According to Qiu, MOSS will be "in line" with moral principles. "We hope to promote this ecology with an open source (generative language) model to avoid duplicated works," Qiu told a Beyond ChatGPT Forum organised by the School of Management, Fudan University. "On the model, you can focus on respective segment development, such as e-commerce, education and medication."

Painting tool Tux Paint adds 15 new magic tools

A new version of the cross-platform, open source, free digital painting and drawing app Tux Paint for kids is now accessible. About ten months after Tux Paint 0.9.28, Tux Paint 0.9.29 is here with fifteen new Magic Tools, such as Maze for creating random mazes, Googly Eyes for adding eyeballs to your creations, Fur for adding fur to a drawing, and Circles and Rays for adding brush stroke effects.

The following new Magic Tools are part of this release: Saturate and Desaturate, a tool to increase and decrease colour saturation; Double Vision, a tool to simulate diplopia; and 3D Glasses, a tool to create 3D images that can be viewed with those red/cyan anaglyph glasses. Remove Color and Keep Color let you fully desaturate sections of an image that match a chosen colour.

RealSense camera based open source face ID now available

Intel's RealSense cameras have been an amazing piece of technology; we've seen a lot of clever hacker uses for them, including robots and smart appliances. Unfortunately, Intel did at one time drop the LiDAR and face tracking-specific models from the RealSense lineup. These, it seems, were not very popular, and neither have we observed them in hacks. That is, up until now. [Lina] provides us with FaceID for Linux, a practical application for the RealSense facial tracking cameras

The project is simple: if the camera's built-in face recognition module recognises you, your lockscreen is unlocked. Since Linux is the intended platform, it must integrate with the pluggable authentication modules (PAM) subsystem for authentication, and a PAM module for RealSense is available to go with it. It is appropriately called pam_sauron.

This module is written in Zig, a contemporary C-like language. It's a fun and self-contained program for one of the F4XX-series RealSense cameras, if you happen to own one. As usual, there are TODOs, like improving the UX and utilising some security features RealSense cameras have.